

Abigail L. Underwood, MSW, LSW

PhD Candidate at The Ohio State University, College of Social Work

She/her/hers

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EDUCATION

PhD in Social Work, 2022 – May 2027 – The Ohio State University, College of Social Work

Master of Social Work, 2018 – 2020 – The Ohio State University, College of Social Work

Bachelor of Arts, Urban Studies and Latin American Studies, August 2014 – May 2018 – Washington University in St. Louis, *cum laude with thesis*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Reproductive health care; access to sexual and reproductive health care; adolescence and young adulthood; health equity; interdisciplinary collaboration; community-based participatory research; population health.

FELLOWSHIPS

2022-2026. Health Policy Research Scholars. *The Robert Wood Johnson Foundation*. \$120,000. See website: <https://healthpolicyresearch-scholars.org/meetthescholars/abigail-underwood/>

2018-2019. University Fellowship for Incoming Graduate Students (merit-based), The Ohio State University. \$25,800 for first year of graduate studies.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journals

7. Gallo, M. F., **Underwood, A.**, Smith, M., Warren, E., Hood, R., & Norris Turner, A. (2026). Knowledge of Legality of Abortion and Other Reproductive Health Practices among Women in Ohio post-Dobbs. *Perspectives on Sexual and Reproductive Health*. [In press]
6. Berlan, E. D., Nikahd, M., Kerlek, A. J., Hyde, J., Manos, B. E., **Underwood, A. L.**, Wu, Q., & Bunger, A. C. (2025). Interest in Contraceptive Information and Initiation Among Adolescents Hospitalized with Psychiatric Disorders. *Journal of Adolescent Health*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jadohealth.2024.12.005>
5. Berlan, E. D., **Underwood, A.**, Hyzak, K. A., Hardy, C., Bode, R., Herrmann, S. A., Kerlek, A., Lauden, S., Dudley III, S. W., Schmerge, C. A., Perry, M. F., Bunger, A. C. (2024).

- Implementation of Contraception Care for Adolescents Hospitalized with Psychiatric Disorders. *Journal of Adolescent Health*.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jadohealth.2024.10.006>
4. Beaujolais, B., McCloskey, R., **Underwood, A.**, Clark Hammond, G. (2024). Ohio Healthcare Professionals' Pandemic-Related Help-Seeking Knowledge, Behaviors, and Concerns. *Workplace Health and Safety*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/21650799241259502>
 3. **Underwood, A.**, Hyzak, K., Ebersole, A., Bunger, A., & Berlan, E. (2024). Assessing Perspectives on an Intervention Connecting Adolescents in Outpatient Psychiatry Care to Contraceptive Counseling in The United States. *Perspectives on Sexual and Reproductive Health*. <http://doi.org/10.1111/psrh.12261>
 2. Hyzak, K., Bunger, A., Herrmann, S., Kerlek, A., Lauden, S., Dudley, S., **Underwood, A.**, & Berlan, E. (2023). Development of an Implementation Blueprint to Scale-Up a Contraception Care Intervention for Adolescents with Psychiatric Conditions in a Pediatric Hospital Setting. *Global Implementation Research and Applications*, 3(2), 147-161. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s43477-023-00082-7>
 1. Hyder, A., Smith, M., Sealy-Jefferson, S., Hood, R., Chettri, S., Dundon, A., **Underwood, A.**, Basset, D., & Norris, A. (2022). A Community-Based Systems Dynamics for Reproductive Health: A Case Study from Urban Ohio. *Progress in Community Health Partnerships: Research, Education, and Action* 16(3), 361-383.
<https://doi.org/10.1353/cpr.2022.0053>

Under Review

1. Christensen, M., Bunger, A., & **Underwood, A.** (Under Review). Suicide Risk Screening in Rural Appalachian School-Based Health Centers (SBHCs): A Formative Study to Guide Implementation of the NIH Clinical Pathway. *Prevention Science*.

Book Reviews

1. **Underwood, A.** (2022). Book Review: Birthing a movement: Midwives, law, and the politics of reproductive care by Cramer, R. A. *Affilia*.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/08861099221119460>.

Reports and Toolkits

2. Franklin County Department of Health, Community Health Improvement Plan 2023-2026. [Contributor with Mighty Crow Media, LLC]. https://myfcph.org/chip_1/
1. Collaborating Across Systems for Program Implementation Toolkit. [Contributor].
<https://u.osu.edu/collaborateforchange/sample-page/resources/collaborating-across-systems-for-program-implementation-caspi-toolkit/>

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

13. Ebersole, A., **Underwood, A.**, Moore, A., Berlan, E. (2026, May 6 – 9). *Implementing Integrated Contraception Counseling for Adolescents During Outpatient Psychiatry Visits – A Quality Improvement Study*. European Society of Contraception Congress, Belgrade, Serbia. [Oral Paper]
12. **Underwood, A.**, Bunger, A., Christensen, M. (2025, December 14 – 17). *Adapting the NIMH Clinical Pathway to Rural Appalachian School-Based Health Centers*. 18th Annual Conference on the Science of Dissemination and Implementation in Health, co-hosted by AcademyHealth and the National Institutes of Health, National Harbor, MD. [Poster]
11. Christensen, M., **Underwood, A.**, Bunger, A. (2025, November 8 – 11). *Enhancing Suicide Prevention in Rural Appalachia: Insights from the PRISM-Guided Adaptation of the NIMH Pathway for School-Based Health Centers*. IASR/AFSP International Summer on Suicide Research, Boston, MA. [Poster]
10. Smith, M., **Underwood, A.**, Warren, E., Norris Turner, A., Gallo, M. (2024, October 19 – 21). *When State Policy Clashed with Opinion: Post-Dobbs Increases in Support for Abortion Among Ohio Women*. Society of Family Planning, Annual Meeting, Detroit, MI. [Poster].
9. Gallo, M., **Underwood, A.**, Smith, M., Warren, E., Norris Turner, A. (2024, October 19 – 21). *Changes in the Knowledge of Abortion Legality Following Dobbs*. Society of Family Planning, Annual Meeting, Detroit, MI. [Poster]
8. **Underwood, A.**, Smith, M., Davis, J., Norris Turner, A., Weiner, I., Gallo, M. (2024, October 19 – 21). *Religiosity and Contraception Behaviors Pre- and Post-Dobbs in Ohio*. Society of Family Planning, Annual Meeting, Detroit, MI. [Poster]
7. **Underwood, A.**, Smith, M., Norris Turner, A., Gallo, M. (2024, June 29 – July 2). *Examining Access to Health Care for Ohio Women in the Post-Dobbs Era*. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting, Baltimore, MD. [Poster]
6. **Underwood, A.**, Bunger, A., Hyzak, K., Hardy, C., Berlan, E. (2024, January 10 – 14). *Examining the Equitable Implementation of a Contraceptive Care Intervention for Adolescents Hospitalized with Psychiatric Conditions*. Society for Social Work Research 28th Annual Conference, Washington, DC. [Poster].
5. **Underwood, A.**, Hyzak, K., Ebersole, A., Bunger, A., Berlan, E. (2023, June 24 – 27). *A Qualitative Investigation of an Intervention Connecting Adolescents in Psychiatric Care to Contraceptive Care*. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting, Seattle, WA. [Poster]
4. Freisthler, B., Chadwick, C., Renick, K., Murphy, I. E., Shockley-McCarthy, K., **Underwood, A.**, Ye, Y. & Wolfe, J. (2021, January 19 – 22). *Parenting During a Pandemic: Assessing*

Parents' Daily Stress and Use of Punitive Punishment. Society for Social Work Research, virtual. [Oral Paper]

3. **Underwood, A.** (2020, January 16 – 19). *Migration from Central America to the United States: A systems dynamics perspective.* Society for Social Work Research, Washington, DC. [Poster]

2. **Underwood, A.** & Flores, Y. (2019) *Pregnant women in migration: Service gaps from a Feminist Perspective.* 4th Binational Mexico—United States Conference on Social Work and Migration, Houston, TX. [Oral Presentation]

1. **Underwood, A.** (2019) *Migration from Central America to the United States: A Systems Dynamics Perspective/Migración de Centroamérica a los Estados Unidos: Una perspectiva de la dinámica de sistemas.* Congreso Nacional E Internacional de Trabajo Social, Cúcuta, Colombia. [Oral Presentation conducted in Spanish]

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, August 2024 – ongoing – The Ohio State University Wexner Medical Center, Division of General Internal Medicine with Dr. Alicia Bunger.

- *Implementing the NIMH Clinical Pathway in Rural Appalachian School-Based Health Clinics.* National Institutes of Mental Health (5R34MH137618-02). (PI: Dr. Mary Christensen, West Virginia University, School of Social Work)
 - Collected qualitative data with health providers in school-based health care centers, recruited parent/child dyads to participate in surveys, and analyzed qualitative data for manuscript.
 - Disseminated preliminary findings at conference presentations and peer-reviewed journal articles.
 - Participated in quality improvement meetings and collected electronic health record data.
- *Staffing and Supports for Implementing Cross-System Interventions with Peer Mentors (COSTARs).* National Institute on Drug Abuse (4R33DA059893-02; 4R61DA059893-02). (PI: Dr. Alicia Bunger)
 - Conducted grant preparation, led focus groups, conducted qualitative data analysis, and supported survey data collection and organization.

Graduate Research Assistant, August 2023 – August 2024 – Ohio Policy Evaluation Network (OPEN) with Dr. Maria Gallo

- *Project B2: Ohio Survey of Women.* Sub-project within the Ohio Policy Evaluation Network Implementation Grant. Anonymous Foundation. (PIs: Dr. Alison Norris and Dr. Danielle Bassett).
 - Conducted data analysis, literature review, manuscript preparation and dissemination.

Graduate Research Assistant, January 2024 – May 2024 – The Ohio State University, College of Social Work with Dr. Gia Barboza-Salerno

- Conducted secondary data analysis, manuscript preparation and dissemination.

Graduate Research Assistant, January 2022 – January 2024 – The Ohio State University, College of Social Work with Dr. Alicia Bunger.

- *Coordination of Outpatient Mental Health Care and Adolescent Family Planning Services Via Telehealth*. Subcontract with Nationwide Children’s Hospital (PI: Dr. Elise Berlan; Nationwide Children’s Hospital).
 - Led a qualitative study to examine provider perspectives and needs related to implementing a contraceptive counseling program for adolescents with mental health needs.
- *Implementation of Contraceptive Care for Hospitalized Adolescents with Mental Health Disorders*. Organon. Subcontract with Nationwide Children’s Hospital (PI: Dr. Elise Berlan; Nationwide Children’s Hospital).
 - Engaged in participant recruitment, data collection, data analysis, and manuscript writing.
- *Ohio START Pilot Project Evaluation*. Public Children Services Association of Ohio (US Department of Justice/OH Attorney General 2019-VOCA-132234677). (PI: Dr. Bridget Freisthler).
 - Conducted qualitative data cleaning, coding, and analysis to understand collaboration strategies, facilitators, and barriers for a state-wide, multi-system intervention program.

Graduate Research Assistant, August 2022 – August 2023 – The Ohio State University, College of Public Health with Dr. Ayaz Hyder.

- *Targeted Investment and Meaningful Engagement to Improve MCH Outcomes and Rectify Historical Structural Racism: The TIME Study*. National Institutes of Health (R01HD109000). Collaboration with Nationwide Children’s Hospital. (PI: Dr. Deena Chisolm).
 - Participated in the core modeling team for systems dynamics modeling; designing and facilitating group model building sessions; data collection; causal loop diagram creation; literature review.

Graduate Research Assistant, January 2019 – May 2020 – The Ohio State University, College of Public Health with Dr. Ayaz Hyder

- *Project C2: Infant and Maternal Mortality*. Sub-project within the Ohio Policy Evaluation Network Implementation Grant. Anonymous Foundation. (PIs: Dr. Alison Norris and Dr. Danielle Bassett).
 - Co-facilitated community-based participatory workshops with reproductive health stakeholders, collaborating to create a systems dynamics policy simulation model

based on the community workshops, reporting the findings to Foundation stakeholders.

- o Website with results of project: <https://open.osu.edu/investigating-ohios-high-infant-mortality/>

Graduate Research Assistant, August 2019 – May 2020 – The Ohio State University, College of Social Work with Dr. Bridget Freisthler

- *Enhancing Permanency in Children and Families Program (EPIC)*. Children's Bureau, Administration for Children and Families, Department of Health and Human Services Grant Number 90CU0083. (PIs: Dr. Bridget Friesthler, Dr. Kathryn Maguire-Jack)
 - o Conducted qualitative data collection, project management, geocoding in geographic information systems (ArcMap), quantitative data cleaning, literature review, codebook creation and maintenance.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Social Work 3201: Social Justice and Social Welfare Policy, Bachelor of Social Work Advanced Writing course. In-person. Spring 2026.

Instructor, Social Work 1120: Introduction to Social Welfare, Bachelor of Social Work/General Education course. Asynchronous online. Summer 2025.

Instructor, Social Work 3401: Research & Statistics for Social Work, Bachelor of Social Work. Asynchronous online. Autumn 2025.

Instructor, Social Work 1120: Introduction to Social Welfare, Bachelor of Social Work/General Education course. Asynchronous online. Autumn 2024.

Guest Lecturer, Social Work 1140: Issues in Social Justice: Race, Gender and Sexuality. *Voting Rights: Women's Rights, Reproductive Rights, and LGBTQ+ Rights*. In-person. Autumn 2024.

Instructor, Social Work 3597: Adolescent Sexual Health, Sexuality and Parenthood: A Global Perspective, Bachelor of Social Work. Asynchronous online. Summer 2024.

Guest Lecturer, Social Work 7640: Community and Social Justice, Master of Social Work. *Leadership*. In-person. Autumn 2022.

SOCIAL WORK EXPERIENCE

Research and Evaluation Assistant, May 2023 – ongoing – Mighty Crow Media, LLC

- Support research and evaluation efforts through literature review, data analysis, manuscript preparation, and writing.

Community-Based Family Therapist, Functional Family Therapy, May 2020 – November 2021 – The Buckeye Ranch

- Provided evidence-based therapy to youth ages 11-18 with behavioral health concerns and their families.
- Collaborated with collateral providers and organizations to serve clients' needs.
- Creatively adapted engagement and therapy strategies to meet family needs during the COVID-19 pandemic.
- Documented all client interactions, maintained online client health records, and conducted assessments to support evidence base.

Kids' Club Program Lead and Social Work Intern, May 2019 – May 2020 – Serving Our Neighbors Ministries

- Lead after-school program for first-generation, school-aged children focused on social /emotional learning, food security and academic assistance.
- Designed, implemented, and facilitated programs to address summer food insecurity for children.
- Organized and visualized data to understand service areas and total clients reached.
- Additional responsibilities included: Volunteer coordination, event planning, program evaluation, client records management and assisting with grant applications.
- Previous titles included: AmeriCorps Summer VISTA (Summer 2017), Summer Associate (Summer 2018, Summer 2019)

Social Work Intern, January 2019 – May 2019 – The Columbus Dream Center

- Responsible for researching, designing, and implementing a case management system for individuals experiencing homelessness. Facilitated programs for youth development and to address food insecurity.

HONORS / AWARDS

2026. Doctoral Student Excellence in Teaching Award. College of Social Work, The Ohio State University. Awarded to one doctoral student annually and presented at the College of Social Work's Evening of Recognition.

2018. *Cum laude with thesis*. Washington University in St. Louis.

SERVICE

2026. Peer Reviewer. *Contraception and Reproductive Medicine*.

2025. Peer Reviewer. *International Journal of Adolescence and Youth*.

2024. Abstract Reviewer. Annual Research Meeting, AcademyHealth.

2023. COLA Week Facilitator. Central Ohio Leadership Academy.

2023. Peer Reviewer. *Reproductive Health*.

2022-2023. President. Doctoral Student Organization, The Ohio State University at the College of Social Work.

2022-2024. Member. Taskforce for Social Work Criminalization. National Association of Social Workers, Ohio Chapter.

2018. Volunteer. Council for Social Work Education, Annual Program Meeting.

2018. Volunteer. Higher Education Center for Alcohol and Drug Misuse Prevention and Recovery, National Meeting.

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATION MEMBERSHIPS

AcademyHealth, member.

Society for Social Work Research, member.

Systems Dynamics Society, member.